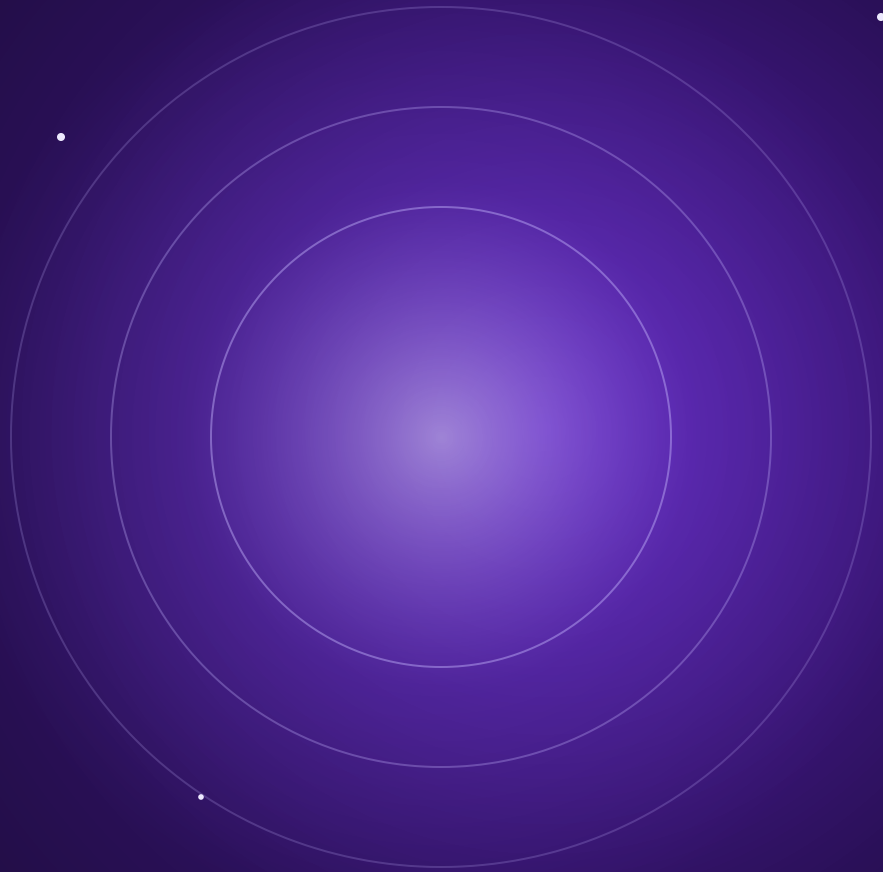




A FREE WORKBOOK

The Belief Audit

Find the belief that was handed to you. See how it was made durable. Then change it.

~ ANNA

FREE



Start here

Some beliefs you chose. Some were handed to you, said so many times that they turned into facts about who you are. This workbook helps you find one of the second kind.

You will work on one belief. By the end you will have a Belief Card: the belief, where it came from, what kept it alive, what the evidence says, and a true message to replace it.

What you will have after each part

- ◆ **Part 1:** a list of your limiting beliefs, and the one you will work on.
- ◆ **Part 2:** a map of where it came from.
- ◆ **Part 3:** which of three forces kept it alive.
- ◆ **Part 4:** a ladder of five whys.
- ◆ **Part 5:** the times the belief was not true.
- ◆ **Part 6:** three affirmations to replace it, and one physical action.
- ◆ **Part 7:** your Belief Card, one action to take right now, and how to add more beliefs.

How to use it

Go in order. Write your answers on paper or in the Notebook. Plan on about 20 minutes a part, and stop whenever you need to. Come back when you are ready.

WHAT THIS IS NOT

This is a self-reflection workbook. It is not therapy, medical advice, or a diagnosis. If something heavy comes up, stop and reach out for real support:

- ◆ Suicidal thoughts or self-harm: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, call or text 988
- ◆ Domestic violence or abuse: National Domestic Violence Hotline, 1-800-799-7233

Where to start

Go to Part 1.

Name the Belief



A belief that was handed to you rarely arrives as an argument. It arrives as a sentence, repeated until it sounds like a fact about you. You can't change a belief you haven't put into words, so we start by naming one.

HOW IT LOOKED FOR ME

Someone in my family said everything twice. Then they added the same three words at the end: before you forget.

Take your coat before you forget. Take your coat before you forget.

I heard it for years. Somewhere in those years I started to forget things: a coat, a name, a plan. I told people I had a bad memory, and I said it like a fact I had always known about myself.

The belief was not "I forget sometimes." It was "I'm the one who forgets." It cost me my memory, and it cost me the ability to believe I could remember. I never tried to fix it, because I was the one who forgot. I first doubted the story around 30, six years ago, when I started asking how I could see what my beliefs were and change them. That was a big belief. Start smaller than I did.

DO THIS NOW

- 1 Write down every sentence you tell yourself about what you can't do, aren't, or never will. Aim for ten. Start them with "I'm the one who...", "I'm not a ___ person", or "I'm just..."
- 2 Circle any you have said for as long as you can remember, or that you can hear in someone else's voice.
- 3 Pick the smallest one, the belief that feels easiest to change. A small win gives you the momentum for the bigger ones.
- 4 Write it as one sentence, in the words you actually hear.
- 5 Rate how true it feels, from 0 to 10. You will rate it again at the end.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 2, you will trace where this belief came from.

Trace the Source



A belief has a first time you heard it or learned it. Finding that moment takes away some of its power, because a belief that came from a person or a circumstance is no longer a fact about you.

HOW IT LOOKED FOR ME

Where did I first hear it? From someone in my family, said twice, with the same three words at the end. How many times? For years. What was I feeling? It sounded like care, and maybe it was. I never decided to believe it. Nobody gave me an argument. I just heard it enough times that it became the background music of a huge chunk of my life.

DO THIS NOW

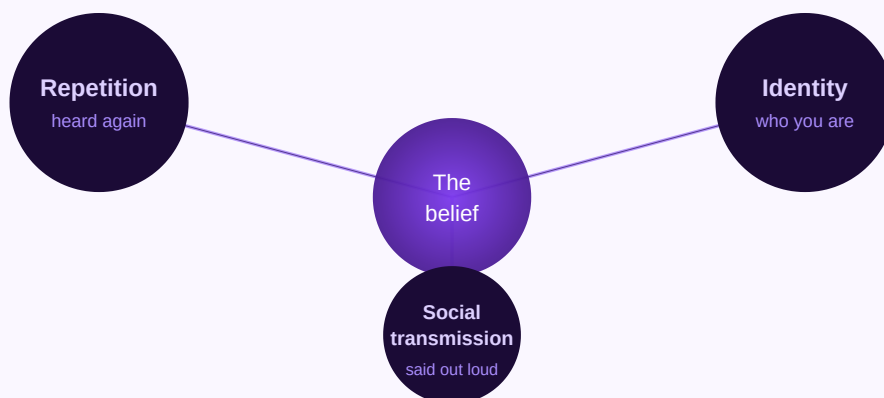
- 1 Write your belief at the top of a page.
- 2 Where did I first hear this, or first learn it? Name the person, the place, or the moment before you name the claim.
- 3 Who else said it, or something like it?
- 4 What happened that made it feel true? An event, a circumstance, or a pattern that kept repeating.
- 5 How many times did I hear it or see it happen? Guess: once, a few times, or for years.
- 6 What was I feeling when it happened? Fear, belonging, or just the sound of it for the hundredth time?
- 7 Did anyone ever give me an argument for it? Write yes or no.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 3, you will see which forces kept it alive.

See the Machine



A message has to be durable before it can be believed, and durability can be manufactured. Three forces do most of the work: repetition, identity, and social transmission. Most beliefs that were handed to you used at least one.



- ◆ **Repetition:** you heard it again and again. Familiarity starts to feel like truth.
- ◆ **Identity:** it became part of who you are. A message that says who we are is a membership card, not an argument.
- ◆ **Social transmission:** you repeated it to other people. What you say out loud hardens.

HOW IT LOOKED FOR ME

Repetition: I heard it for years. Identity: it became an essential part of my identity. I was the one who forgets. Social transmission: I told people I had a bad memory, and I said it like a fact I had always known about myself. All three were at work.

DO THIS NOW

- 1 Copy your belief at the top of a page.
- 2 Repetition: how often did you hear it, and from whom? Write a number or a guess.
- 3 Identity: does it sound like a description of who you are, such as "I'm the one who..."? Write yes or no, and the exact words.
- 4 Social transmission: do you say it to other people? Write down the last time you did.
- 5 Circle the force that was strongest.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 4, you will ask why, five times.

Ask Why Five Times



Awareness is the first move. When you can see a belief, you are no longer inside it, and that gap is where change starts. One simple way to widen it is to ask why, again and again, until you reach what is underneath.

1. Why do I believe this?

2. Why does that matter?

3. Why did I take it as true?

4. Why do I keep saying it?

5. Why does that matter now? (stop at a feeling or a person)

HOW IT LOOKS (AN ILLUSTRATION, NOT A REAL PERSON)

Belief: "I'm not a math person."

1. Why do I believe that? Because I failed a fractions quiz in fourth grade.
2. Why did one quiz matter so much? Because my teacher said some people just aren't math people.
3. Why did I take the teacher's word for it? Because she was the adult and I was nine.
4. Why did I keep saying it years later? Because my friends nodded, and it made me feel like I belonged.
5. Why does that matter now? Because I have been protecting a story about who I am, not looking at what I can do.

DO THIS NOW

- 1 Write your belief at the top of a page.
- 2 Ask: why do I believe this? Write the answer.
- 3 Ask why again about your answer. Repeat until you have asked five times.
- 4 Stop when you reach a feeling or a person, not a fact.
- 5 Write one sentence on what you notice.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 5, you will look for the times the belief was not true.

The Times It Was Not True



A belief that was handed to you was never tested. Nobody checked it against your life. So you check it now, and not by arguing with it. You look for the times it was wrong.

HOW IT LOOKS (AN ILLUSTRATION, NOT A REAL PERSON)

Belief: "I'm not a math person."

- ◆ I split a restaurant bill in my head last month and got it right.
- ◆ I doubled a recipe without a calculator.
- ◆ A coworker once asked me to check her budget numbers.

None of these proves she is a math person. They prove the belief is not always true, and a belief with exceptions is no longer a fact.

DO THIS NOW

- 1 Write your belief at the top of a page.
- 2 List every time the belief was not true, even once. Small counts.
- 3 List times you did the opposite of what the belief says.
- 4 List times someone else saw you differently, and what they said.
- 5 Write what happened, not what it meant. Keep it to facts.
- 6 Look at the list. Write one sentence: "The belief is not always true. Here is what I see."
- 7 Rate how true the belief feels now, from 0 to 10.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 6, you will write affirmations to replace it, and do one physical thing.

Replace It, Then Do One Physical Thing



The same forces that built the belief can build a better one. Repetition, identity, and social transmission are not the problem. The line is whether the message tells the truth about something real. A replacement that is too big to believe will not hold, so write three affirmations, from the easiest to believe to the one you are aiming for.

Then do something physical. You have to do something in the real world to change a belief and your identity. For me, it was paying for ghostwriting training. I learned quickly that my writing can make money, and the old belief stopped being the only story I had.

HOW IT LOOKS (AN ILLUSTRATION, NOT A REAL PERSON)

Old belief: "I'm not a math person."

Affirmation 1 (easy to believe): "I got some math right this week."

Affirmation 2: "I can learn the math I don't know yet."

Affirmation 3 (the one you are aiming for): "I'm someone who can work with numbers."

Physical action: add up one receipt and check the total.

DO THIS NOW

- 1 Write the opposite of your belief. Check it against Part 5.
- 2 Turn it into three affirmations. Start with one you already believe at least 8 out of 10. Make the second a step further, around 6. Make the third the one you are aiming for, even if you only believe it 4 or 5 out of 10.
- 3 Make each one true about something real. If you can't believe it at least a little, make it smaller.
- 4 Write them as sentences you can say out loud.
- 5 Pick one physical action that proves it, small enough to do right now, in the next five to ten minutes.
- 6 Do it now. Then write down what you did.

WHAT'S NEXT In Part 7, you will put it all on one card.

Your Belief Card and Next Steps



The belief	
Where it came from (Part 2)	
The force that kept it alive (Part 3)	
What I found at the bottom of the whys (Part 4)	
Times it was not true (Part 5)	
My affirmations (Part 6)	
My physical action, done (Part 6)	
How true it felt at the start (0 to 10)	
How true it feels now (0 to 10)	

DO THIS RIGHT NOW

That is the whole minimum. It should take five to ten minutes.

- 1 Say your first affirmation out loud, once.
- 2 Do your physical action.
- 3 Rate the belief again, from 0 to 10. Write the number next to your first one.

Then add beliefs slowly

One belief at a time. Go back to your list from Part 1.

- 1 Pick the next smallest belief, the one that feels easiest to change.
- 2 Run it through Parts 2 to 7 again. It goes faster the second time.
- 3 Each small win gives you the momentum to take on a larger belief.
- 4 Save the biggest belief for last.

WHAT'S NEXT This is one belief. You probably have more. [Link to the 21-Day Belief Reset goes here, once it is built.]